thinks about the world.

Smith contends that present theoretical perspectives as based on:

- Foundational theoretical position which states that all truth claims can be judged true or false. Neo–neo debate, historical sociology and critical theory seem to be foundational.
- Anti-foundational theoretical position which contends that truth claims cannot be so judged since there are never neutral grounds for doing so. Post-modernism, some feminist theories, normative theories tend to be anti-foundational.

Smith further characterizes the theories into two categories:

- Rationalist, constituting the neo-liberal and neo-realist theoretical positions.
- Reflectivist, constituting the non-positivistic theories.

Smith argues that present day IR is, therefore, characterized by three principal trends: [Figure 1.1]

- Continuing dominance of the three theories—Realism, Liberalism and Modern World System theory—constituting the rationalist position and epitomized by the 'neo–neo' debate.
- Emergence of non-positivistic theories marking the reflectivist position.
- Development of an approach that seeks a rapprochement between the rationalist and reflectivist positions and is epitomized by the social constructivist position.[25]

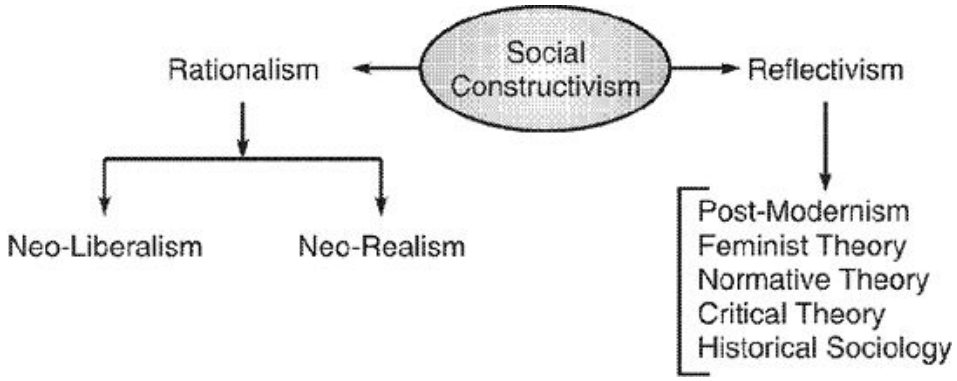


Figure 1.1 Classification of international relations theory in the late 1990s.

[**Source:** Adapted from Steve Smith][25].